THE SHIFTING MAP

States with the highest increase and decrease, and degradation, in forest cover, area wise

HIGHEST RISE

ANDHRA PRADESH

2023	INCREASE
30,085 sq. km	4,041 sq. km
2013	↑16%
26,044 sq. km	

KERALA

2023	INCREASE
22,059 sq. km	3,675 sq. km
2013	↑20%
18,384 sq. km	

HIGHEST FALL

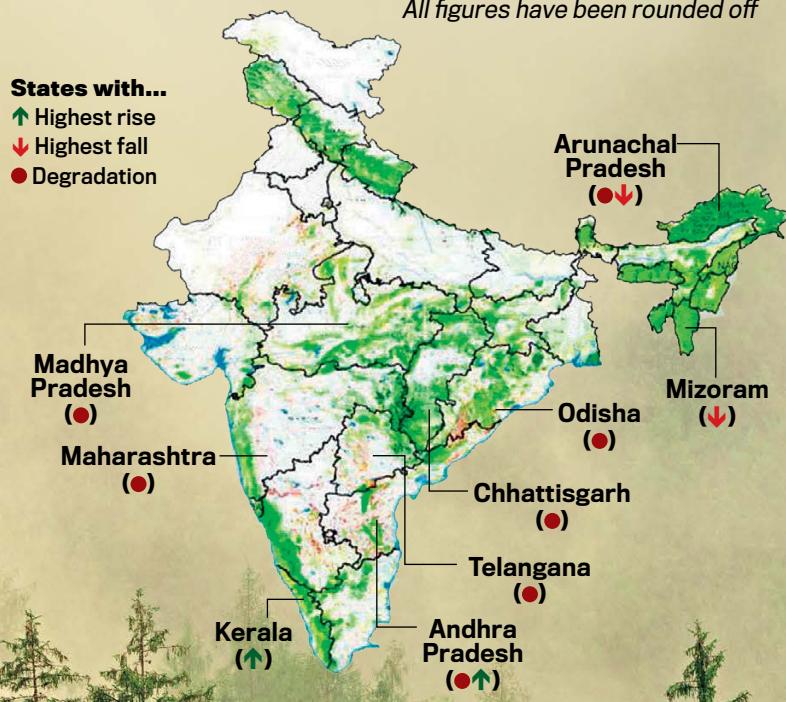
ARUNACHAL PRADESH

2023	DECREASE
65,881 sq. km	1,084 sq. km
2013	↓1.6%
66,966 sq. km	

MIZORAM

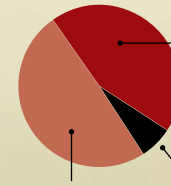
2023	DECREASE
17,990 sq. km	988 sq. km
2013	↓5.2%
18,978 sq. km	

All figures have been rounded off



DECADAL DEGRADATION FROM 2011 TO 2021 (SQ. KM)

92,989
The national forest cover that has degraded



40,709
From VDF and MDF to OF inside RFA

46,707
From VDF, MDF, OF, Scrub to Non-forest inside RFA

5,573
From VDF, MDF and OF to Scrub inside RFA

● States with maximum forest degradation

(in sq. km)

MADHYA PRADESH 10,554	CHHATTISGARH 5,953
ARUNACHAL PRADESH 6,539	ANDHRA PRADESH 5,561
MAHARASHTRA 6,227	ODISHA 5,466
	TELANGANA 4,926

*Andhra Pradesh's presence in 'Degradation' as well as 'Rise' tables illustrates the shift to 'Manmade forests'; **VDF** or Very Dense Forests have a canopy density of ≥ 70%; **MDF** (Moderately Dense Forests) 40-70%; **OF** (Open Forests) 10-40%; **Scrub** <10%; **RFA**: Recorded Forest Area; canopy density: ratio of ground covered by crowns of trees; non-forest lands: cropland, settlements etc.*

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY